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accounts on an app or paying money on an app, saving or buying investment on an app and it is the app and its UI/UX, it's gamification that matters and not the underlying bank or broker or even an investment idea.

This is not about my view on markets and retail participation alone. The biggest dynamic that one needs to be aware of today is that an overwhelmingly large proportion of our investors are going to be young in the coming years. Twenty years ago, if the median age of the investor in mutual funds was 45-55 years, in the next 10 years it will be a 30. And a 30-year-old with a very different journey to that point and a very

different route map onward. This is the biggest dynamic the industry needs to prepare for. We are way too complex, way too boring and unnecessarily intellectual.

The entire digital ecosystem and changing consumer trends have made the industry democratic and meritocratic. In the past, most mutual fund companies were owned by a bank, insurance company, NBFC or broker or some sort of conglomerate. Today, professional managers with no institution buttressing their claim to competency but a reputation and track record to boot, are setting up their mutual fund companies, thanks to regulations in no small manner.

More and more new players will come in based on the rise in market size, global investment opportunities, and the ability to create products and deploy investment acumen. But success will lie not just in managing money and generating returns, but it will depend a lot more on accessibility, communication quality, and, most importantly, relatability.

How does one stay young and keep an organisation young despite the much desirable grey of experience and competency is what I wonder most about nowadays. **BT**

The author is CEO, White Oak Capital Mutual Fund. Views are personal